Unit 3: Renewable Energy

# Listening and Speaking: Mir'aah solar project

**Lesson 3-3**
Book pages 30-31

💡 **Big idea:** We listen to a **presentation** about the **Mir'aah Solar Project** in Oman, which uses a **solar steam generator** with large mirrors to make steam to extract oil. We learn how to talk about **advantages and disadvantages**.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Predict the content of a presentation from slides
- Listen and complete missing information
- Sort statements into advantages and disadvantages
- Discuss renewable energy ideas for Oman

## 📖 Key words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **presentation** عرض تقديمي | **advantage** ميزة | **disadvantage** عيب | **extract** يستخرج |
| **oilfield** حقل نفط | **steam** بخار | **mirror** مرآة | **maintenance** صيانة |
| **cost-effective** فعال من حيث التكلفة | **outweigh** يفوق | | |

### Mir'aah Solar Project

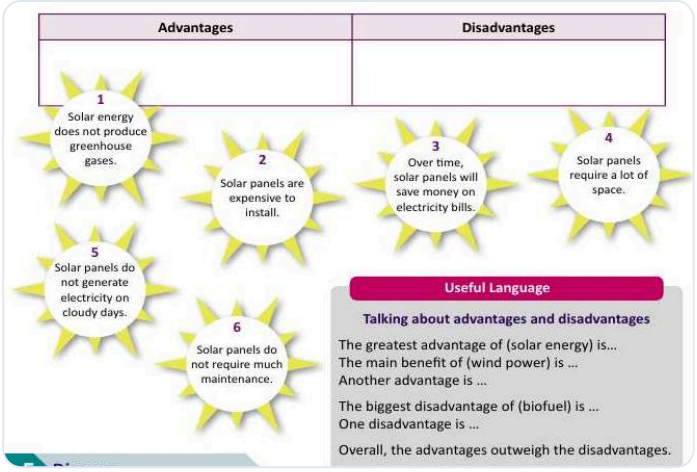
- One of the **largest solar energy plants in the world**, in an **oilfield** in Oman
- Uses **large mirrors** to focus sunlight and generate **steam**
- The steam is used to **extract oil**
- Reduces the oilfield's carbon footprint by about **300,000 tonnes** a year

### Solar energy: pros and cons

- **Advantages**: does not produce greenhouse gases, saves money on electricity bills over time, does not require much maintenance
- **Disadvantages**: panels are expensive to install, require a lot of space, do not generate electricity on cloudy days

### Talking about advantages and disadvantages

- The greatest advantage of (solar energy) is ...
- The main benefit of (wind power) is ...
- Another advantage is ...
- The biggest disadvantage of (biofuel) is ...
- One disadvantage is ...
- Overall, the advantages **outweigh** the disadvantages




Advantages and disadvantages of solar energy

## ✏️ Examples

**Is "Solar panels require a lot of space" an advantage or disadvantage?**

**Answer: A disadvantage**

**What does Mir'aah use to generate steam?**

**Answer: Large mirrors that focus the sun's heat**

**Give your opinion about wind turbines at school using the Useful Language**

**Answer: The greatest advantage is free electricity. One disadvantage is the noise. Overall, the advantages outweigh the disadvantages.**

### ⭐ Remember

- Look at the slides before listening and predict the content
- Use numbers and names as key words while listening

### ⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ The advantage of solar is expensive. ✓ One disadvantage of solar is that it is expensive.
- ✗ Mir'aah uses solar panels. ✓ Mir'aah uses large mirrors.

🧩 **Activity:** Discuss three ideas for renewable energy at your school using the Useful Language

### ✅ Check yourself

1. Where is Mir'aah?
2. What is the steam used for?
3. One disadvantage of solar panels?

Answers: (1) in an oilfield in Oman ، (2) to extract oil ، (3) expensive to install